

Workflow A[i]gent – Automated Interview Workflows

Interview Stage Automation & Orchestration Engine – [View Demo](#)

Workflow A[i]gent is a modular system of interview workflows, automations, and communication templates designed to reduce no-shows, enforce SLAs, and standardize candidate and interviewer experience across every stage of the funnel.

This agent was originally implemented during an ATS migration (to Greenhouse) and is designed to be **ATS-agnostic**: the patterns and logic can be applied to any modern recruiting stack.

1. Problem & Outcomes

1.1 The Problem

Most interview processes silently leak:

- Candidates no-show or drop after scheduling
- Interviewers don't submit scorecards on time
- Hiring managers forget feedback, slowing decisions
- Candidates get inconsistent information across stages
- Recruiters manually chase everyone, all the time

This creates:

- Longer time-to-fill
- Lower close rates
- Higher operational drag on the recruiting team
- Low Candidate Satisfaction
- Poor Employer Branding

1.2 What Workflow A[i]gent Does

Workflow A[i]gent standardizes and automates:

- **Scheduling & availability capture**
- **Interview confirmations & reminders**
- **Candidate expectations & prep**
- **Scorecard SLAs & nudges**

- **Status / delay updates**
- **Offer & pre-onboarding communication**

The result is an **interview pipeline that moves on its own**, with recruiters focusing on judgement calls instead of calendar and reminder work.

2. Scope & Design Principles

2.1 In-scope

- Phone screen → HM/Tech → Panel → Final → Offer → Pre-start
- Candidate + interviewer + HM communications
- Time-based triggers & SLAs
- Template library (email + calendar text)
- ATS-native automation rules (e.g., Greenhouse, Lever)

2.2 Out-of-scope (v1)

- Automated notetaking / transcription
- LLM-generated feedback summaries
- Candidate sourcing / nurture campaigns
- Post-hire onboarding workflows

Those are handled by other A[i]gents in the portfolio.

2.3 Design Principles

- **Candidate-first:** clear expectations, no surprises
- **Low change-management lift:** built on native ATS features
- **Observable:** every automation is traceable in the ATS timeline
- **Configurable:** stages and templates can be swapped per role / region
- **Fail-safe:** humans can override or pause any automation

2.4 Global Rules (applied to all automations)

- **Time Zone:** send in candidate's local time; show both candidates + host times
- **Reschedule / Cancel:** always include a self-service link and coordinator alias
- **Accessibility:** ask about accommodations in every invite, include phone backup
- **Privacy:** no sensitive data in calendar bodies; link to secure docs instead
- **Branding:** consistent subject format - [Company] · [Role] · [Stage]
- **Localization:** templates must support region-specific phrasing and legal notes

3. Roles & Responsibilities

Roles	Responsibilities
Recruiter (R)	Owns candidate communication Monitors automation logs Manually intervenes for exceptions
Coordinator (C)	Manages scheduling exceptions Reschedules + calendar logistics
Hiring Manager	Prepares for interviews Submits decision & scorecards within SLA Participates in escalations
Interviewers	Conduct interviews Submit structured feedback promptly
Recruiting Ops / ATS Admin	Maintains templates Manages automation rules Owns SLA dashboards
Owner	Diane Wilkinson — design, implementation, continuous improvement

4. System Overview

At a high level, Workflow A[i]gent delivers:

1. Scheduling Workflows

- Availability capture emails
- Reminders if candidates don't respond
- Alerts to recruiters when threads stall

2. Stage-based Interview Workflows

- Confirmation + reminder + follow-up for each stage
- Interviewer reminders + scorecard nudges
- Standard rejection comms

3. SLAs & Escalations

- Scorecards due within X hours

- Automatic escalation to HM / recruiting lead if overdue
- Visibility for recruiting ops

4. Candidate Status & Delay Updates

- Automated “we’re still here” nudges during longer assessments
- Role-based messaging for delays (hiring manager out, role on hold, etc.)

5. Offer / Pre-Start Workflows

- Offer scheduling + confirmation
- “What to expect” between offer accept and start date

4.1 ATS Implementation Guide

Implementation Checklist

- ☐ Create templates
- ☐ Map triggers
- ☐ Define SLAs
- ☐ Configure interviewer reminders
- ☐ Enable “block advancement until scorecards complete”
- ☐ Load automation rules
- ☐ Test using sample candidate
- ☐ Train team
- ☐ Monitor metrics

5. Workflow Library

Below is the *conceptual* library of workflows that live inside Workflow A[i]gent. Implementation details (trigger wiring, exact templates) are documented in sub-files and can be adapted to any ATS.

5.1 Trigger Glossary

- **Stage Change:** Triggered when ATS stage is updated
- **Event Booked:** Triggered when an interview calendar event is created
- **Time-Based:** Triggered relative to interview start, stage-entered timestamp, or set time in stage has elapsed.
- **Manual Override:** Recruiter-triggered email templates

5.2 Scheduling & Availability

Goal: Reduce drop-off between “stage change” and “time booked.”

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
S1	Stage Change → Initial Screen	Candidate	Send: [SCHED_Availability_Initial]
S2	No reply after 48h	Candidate	Send: [SCHED_Availability_Nudge]
S3	No reply after 96h	Recruiter	Send: [HT_SCHED_Alert]
S4	Stage Change → Technical/HM	Candidate	Send: [SCHED_Availability_Tech]
S5	Event Booked: Tech Interview	Candidate	Send: [SCHED_Availability_Tech_Prep]
S6	Stage Change: Final Interview	Candidate	Send: [SCHED_Availability_Final]
S7	Event Booked: Final Interview	Candidate	Send: [SCHED_Availability_Final_Prep]

5.3 Interview Stage Workflows

For each stage (Screen, HM/Tech, Panel, Final), the pattern is:

- CONFIRM – immediate
- REMIND – 24 hours before
- REINFORCE – optional same-day reminder for virtual/onsite
- FOLLOW-UP – 2–4 hours after
- SCORECARD NUDGES – to interviewers until completed

Example: Initial Interview

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
I1	Event Booked → Initial Screen	Candidate	Send: [CONF_Initial_Interview]
I2	Time-based: Reminder [-24h]	Candidate	Send: [REM_Initial_Interview]
I3	Time-based: Follow up [+2 h]	Candidate	Send: [COMMS_Initial_FollowUp]
I4	Delayed [+7d/ +14d/ +21d]	Candidate	Send: [COMMS_Update_#1-3]
I5	Stage Change: Removed	Candidate	Send: [REJ_Initial]

Example: Technical or Hiring Manager Interview

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
T1	Event Booked → Interview	Candidate	Send: [CONF_Tech_Interview]

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
T2	Time-based: Reminder [-24h]	Candidate	Send: [REM_Tech_Interview]
T3	Time-based: Follow up [+2 h]	Candidate	Send: {COMMS_Tech_FollowUp}
T4	Time-based: Reminder [-24h]	Interviewer	Send: [HT_REM_Tech_Interview]
T5	Time-based: Scorecard [+2h/+24h]	Interviewer	Send: [HT_REM_Scorecard_Nudge]
T6	Delayed [+7d/ +14d/ +21d]	Candidate	Send: [COMMS_Update_#1-3]
T7	Stage Change: Removed	Candidate	Send: [REJ_Technical]

Example: Final Interview

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
F1	Event Booked → Interview	Candidate	Send: [CONF_Final_Interview]
F2	Time-based: Reminder [-24h]	Candidate	Send: [REM_Final_Interview]
F3	Time-based: Follow up [+2 h]	Candidate	Send: {COMMS_Final_FollowUp}
F4	Time-based: Reminder [-24h]	Interviewer	Send: [HT_REM_Final_Interview]
F5	Time-based: Scorecard [+2h/+24h]	Interviewer	Send: [HT_REM_Scorecard_Nudge]
F6	Delayed [+7d/ +14d/ +21d]	Candidate	Send: [COMMS_Update_#1-3]
F7	Stage Change: Removed	Candidate	Send: [REJ_Final]

5.4 Scorecard & SLA Automation

Objective: Ensure interview feedback is submitted while the conversation is fresh.

Example SLA Pattern:

- **+2h after interview** – first nudge
- **+24h after interview** – second nudge + Slack / email to HM
- **+48h after interview** – escalation to recruiting lead and HM's manager
- **Blocked candidate progression** – candidate cannot move to next stage until scorecards are complete (configurable per role)

These SLAs are wired via:

- ATS time-based automation rules (where available), and/or
- Calendar follow-ups using recruiter/coordinator tasks

5.5 Status & Delay Updates

Objective: Protect candidate experience when internal timelines slip.

Examples:

- “We’re still actively interviewing and expect next steps by <date>”
- “Your interview feedback is under review, thank you for your patience”
- “This role is temporarily on hold – here’s what that means for you”

Delay updates can be triggered:

- Manually from a “**Delay**” email template bank, or
- Automatically after X days in stage without a decision (where ATS supports this)

5.6 Offer & Pre-Start Workflows

Objective: Close offers thoughtfully and avoid “silence” between accept and start.

Examples:

- Offer scheduling link or direct recruiter outreach
- Confirmation of offer call + agenda
- Post-accept email with: what to expect, paperwork, first-day logistics
- Optional reminder 1 week before start with building/remote instructions

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
O1	Event: Offer Approved	Candidate	Send: [OFFER_Extend]
O2	Offer Delayed [+3d / +7d]	Candidate	Send: [COMMS_Update_O]
O3	Event: Offer Not Approved	Recruiter	Send: [HT_Alert_O]
O4	Event: Offer Not Accepted	Candidate	Send: [COMMS_Offer_Declined]

ID	Trigger	Recipient	Action / Template
N1	Event: Offer Approved	Candidate	Send: [ONB_What2Expect]
N2	Time-based: Pre-start [-2w]	Candidate	Send: [ONB_Intros]

6. Configuration & Implementation Notes

Workflow A[i]gent was originally implemented on **Greenhouse**, but the design is ATS-agnostic.

Typical implementation steps:

1. **Map current stages** → Screen, HM/Tech, Panel, Final, Offer.
2. **Define SLAs** for each stage (scorecards, response times, etc.).
3. **Create template library** (confirmation, reminder, follow-up, delay, regret).
4. **Wire triggers** using ATS automation features:
 - On stage change
 - On event booked
 - On time since interview
5. **Pilot on 1–2 roles** (e.g., Sales + Eng) before expanding portfolio-wide.
6. **Train recruiters, coordinators, and HMs** on what's automated vs. manual.
7. **Monitor metrics & tune:** no-show rate, SLA adherence, average days per stage.

6.1 Role-Based Customization

Workflow A[i]gent supports variations by role family:

- Sales (multi-round panel, heavy prep)
- Engineering (technical assessment linkage)
- G&A (faster stage progression)
- Leadership roles (multi-panel + executive approvals)

Each role config supports:

- Custom templates
- Custom SLAs
- Conditional prep packets
- Variable panel sizes

6.2 ATS Configuration Example (Simplified)

- Automation: When Candidate enters “Recruiter Screen” → Send Email Template
- Automation: When No Response 48h → Send Reminder
- Automation: When Interview Ends → Send Scorecard Reminder
- Task: If scorecard overdue 24h → Assign HM Task

7. Metrics & Reporting

Workflow A[i]gent is designed to be measured. Suggested metrics:(See Metrics Dictionary for definitions & formulas)

- No-show rate by stage
- Average days in each interview stage
- % scorecards submitted within SLA
- Candidate satisfaction (CSAT / NPS, where available)
- Template usage rate (how often standard comms are used)
- Volume of “delay update” communications sent
- Time Initial Screen → Manager Interview median
- Scorecards on-time (% within 24h)
- Pass-through Screen → Panel; Panel → Offer
- Template adoption (% automated vs. ad-hoc emails)
- Recruitment Update usage (delays covered)

These metrics can feed into **Metrics A[i]gent** dashboards for holistic funnel visibility.

7.1 Assets in this folder

- <https://dianewilkinson.github.io/agents/workflow/index.html> - Workflow A[i]gent demo UI (timeline + comms viewer)
- <https://dianewilkinson.github.io/agents/workflow/README.md> - GitHub overview
- <https://dianewilkinson.github.io/assets/playbook-automated-workflows.pdf> - this full SOP with trigger tables

7.2 Metrics Dictionary Integration

Workflow A[i]gent emits standardized timestamps and event objects that map 1:1 to the Metrics Dictionary fields:

Event emitted by Workflow Agent	Metrics Dictionary Field	Used For
stage_entered_at	stage_start_time	Time-in-stage calculations
interview_scheduled_at	interview_scheduled_time	SLA tracking, throughput
interview_start_at	interview_start_time	Wait time, candidate friction
interview_end_at	interview_end_time	Feedback freshness calculations
scorecard_submitted_at	scorecard_submitted_time	SLA compliance
offer_extended_at	offer_extended_time	Time-to-offer
delay_update_sent_at	delay_update_sent	Delay coverage & CX metrics

These events allow Metrics A[i]gent to compute:

- Time in each stage / Stage duration (median & percentile)
- Stage pass-through
- SLA adherence (scorecards, scheduling, response times)
- No-show rate by stage
- Interview-to-decision velocity
- Delay-coverage % (roles that received an update)
- Candidate friction (days between interviews)
- Pass-through rates across Screen → Panel → Offer

Workflow A[i]gent = data generator

Metrics A[i]gent = analytics engine

Metrics Dictionary = the shared normalization layer

8. Future Enhancements (AI-Forward Roadmap)

While this version is built using native ATS automation only, it is intentionally designed to support AI in future iterations:

- LLM-generated delay updates using a structured tone / policy
- Automated interview summaries (via *Interview A[i]gent*) feeding into scorecards
- Dynamic choice of templates based on candidate risk (e.g., high-value roles)
- Automated detection of SLA risk and proactive alerting in Slack / Teams
- “Interview Quality” analytics across interviewers and stages

9. How This Fits in the A[i]gents Suite

Workflow A[i]gent Workflow A[i]gent emits clean events and timestamps (stage change, interview booked, scorecard submitted, delay update sent) that Metrics A[i]gent ingests to compute time-in-stage, SLA adherence, and no-show rate using the shared Metrics Dictionary.

- **Upstream:**
 - *Screening A[i]gent* – evaluates inbound applicants and routes to interviews
- **Core:**
 - *Workflow A[i]gent* – orchestrates all interview-stage communications & SLAs
- **Downstream:**
 - *Metrics A[i]gent* – analyzes time-to-fill, pass-through, and SLA performance

- *Interview A[i]gent* (future) – note-taking and structured feedback

Together, they form an **AI-ready, automation-first recruiting operating system**.

10. Risks & Mitigations

- **Risk:** Over-automation → Candidates feel robotic
Mitigation: Mix in human touchpoints; configure warm tone templates
- **Risk:** Incorrect triggers → Wrong emails sent
Mitigation: Use sandbox testing on dummy candidate
- **Risk:** Hiring managers ignore SLAs
Mitigation: Escalation routing, Slack reminders, scorecard gating

Appendix A: Template Legend

Scheduling (SCHED_*)

[SCHED_Availability_Initial] — initial interview scheduling
[SCHED_Availability_Nudge] — follow-up after 2d no reply
[SCHED_Availability_Tech]
[SCHED_Availability_Tech_Prep]
[SCHED_Availability_Final] — final interview scheduling
[SCHED_Availability_Final_Prep]

Confirmations (CONF_*)

[CONF_Initial_Interview] — initial phone screen confirmation
[CONF_Tech_Interview] — technical / hiring manager interview confirmation
[CONF_Final_Interview] — final interview confirmation

Reminders (REM_*)

[REM_Interview_24h] — 24-hour reminder
[REM_Scorecard_2h] / [REM_Scorecard_24h] / [REM_Scorecard_48h]

Comms (COMMS_*)

[COMMS_Blank_Note] — ad-hoc candidate comms
[COMMS_Recruitment_Update_#1-#3] — keep-warm cadence for delays
[COMMS_Resignation_Ack] — candidate withdrawal acknowledgment

Regret (REJ_*)

[REJ_Application] — after application review
[REJ_Position_Filled_Not_Interviewed] — role closed pre-screen
[REJ_Position_Filled_Interviewed] — role closed post-interview
[REJ_1on1_Stages] — after recruiter/HM interviews
[REJ_Final] — after panel

Offer & Onboarding (OFFER_, ONB_)

[OFFER_Extend] — extend offer to candidate
[ONB_WhatToExpect] — post-acceptance #1
[ONB_Intros] — post-acceptance #2 (introductions & next steps)

Token legend: {JOB_NAME}, {CANDIDATE_NAME}, {CANDIDATE_FIRST_NAME},
{CANDIDATE_EMAIL}, {INTERVIEW_NAME}, {SENDER_EMAIL},